PassFrame
TUITION

The Gloomwood Beast

Year 5 — 11+ Homework Worksheet (PassFrame Tuition)

Comprehension | Poetry

Extract (poem) — read it carefully before answering

'Twas creepling dusk, and shadows thin
did flimmer through the Gloomwood trees;
the mossfrogs croaked a wurbling din,
and bramblecrows coughed on the breeze.

'Beware the Beast of Gloomwood deep,
my child,' the old woodcutter said,
'whose griplefangs will never sleep,
whose eyes burn ember-coal-ash-red.'

So Finn set out with blunted blade
to face the Beast in twilight air;
he crossed the Whistling Glen, unafraid,
though brindlewisps tugged at his hair.

The Beast arose with a thrundering roar,
all scalesmoke, claw, and creaking bone —
but Finn stood firm upon the floor
and would not face the dark alone.

One swift-struck blow, one blazing cry,
the Beast lay still beneath the moon.
Finn wiped his blade and gave a sigh,
then whistled home a gentle tune.

'Oh, bravest child!' the woodcutter beamed,
'you've slain the Beast that haunts our land!'
And through the Gloomwood, sunlight streamed,
for peace, once more, was close at hand.

Questions

25 min · 12 questions

1. What time of day does the poem begin?

2. What weapon does Finn carry?

3. Underline the line that tells you the Beast made a loud noise when it appeared.

4. Underline the description of the Beast's eyes.

5. Using the clues in the poem, what do you think “brindlewisps” might be?

6. Put these events in order: the woodcutter warns Finn / Finn strikes the Beast / Finn crosses the Whistling Glen / sunlight streams through Gloomwood.

7. Why might the poet have used invented words instead of real ones to describe the Beast?

8. What clues suggest the Beast had been a danger to the village before Finn arrived?

9. How does the poem's mood change from the beginning to the end?

10. What do you think “scalesmoke” might describe, based on the two words it combines?

11. Find and copy the invented word used to describe the sound the Beast made.

12. Write your own two-line nonsense verse in the style of this poem, using at least one invented word.